

Edition Motors to invest ₹ 50 billion in Uttar Pradesh

South Korean EV giant Edition Motors has expressed its interest in investing almost fifty billion rupees to set up its production facility in Uttar Pradesh. It has proposed to invest five to seven billion rupees in the first phase, ten to fifteen billion rupees in the second phase, and twenty to thirty billion rupees in the third phase for its EV plant in UP.

A delegation of South Korean electric vehicle manufacturer, Edison Motors, met Uttar Pradesh chief minister Yogi Adityanath at his official residence in Lucknow. They talked about their desire to set up an electric vehicle plant in the state. They also said that this would create fresh employment opportunities for 5,000 people.

Okaya Power Group teams up with Prakriti E-Mobility for EV charging stations

Okaya Power has announced a strategic partnership with Prakriti E-Mobility Private Limited for providing charging stations to the fleet operations of Prakriti E-Mobility. Okaya said that its lithium-ion batteries and EV chargers with intelligent BMS have all the safety features to protect the battery and the vehicle.

Nimish Trivedi, co-founder and CEO, Prakriti E-Mobility Private Limited says, "The partnership with Okaya Power is very important to us, as it will help mitigate a major concern hindering the adoption of EVs in the country—the absence of adequate charging infrastructure. We are confident that this partnership will not only help us provide a robust charging infrastructure but also provide a much-needed impetus to the overall EV ecosystem in India."

25 per cent reduction already over the past five years.

The Delhi EV policy aims to register 500,000 EVs in the city by 2024. It will be driven by a bunch of incentives offered by the state government through its newly incorporated State EV Fund and State Electric Vehicle Board, which will be chaired by transport minister Kailash Gahlot.

The Delhi chief minister says that the Delhi EV policy is one of the better policies among all those announced around the world, targeted to curb air pollution. It aims to give a boost to the economy of Delhi after getting a major setback due to coronavirus. He adds that it will give a strong impetus to the economy of the city.

The policy will also see the establishment of a dedicated EV cell to implement the policy at the ground level. The policy has been rolled out for the next three years and it will be reviewed from time to time.

Government puts imports restrictions on colour televisions

India has imposed restrictions on the import of colour television sets, bringing back curbs it had lifted almost two decades ago, in a measure to encourage domestic production. Imports of TVs in certain

categories will now require a licence from the government.

"Import policy of colour television sets is amended from 'free' to 'restricted'," the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) says in a notification, adding that it would separately issue the procedure for the grant of licence.

The curbs are applicable to TV sets included in the 'other colour' category that covers LCD TVs among the goods. There is no restriction on monochrome TVs. The total imports under the restricted category in fiscal 2020 were 781 million dollars. Of these, Vietnam and China accounted for 428.37 million dollars and 292.48 million dollars, respectively.

At present, around 35 per cent of TV sets sold in the country are imported. TVs are some of the non-essential goods whose imports India wants to cut down to boost domestic manufacturing. Sports goods, toys, and plastic goods are some other categories that are likely to face import restrictions.

The chairman of homegrown contract manufacturer Dixon Technologies, Sunil Vachani, says the move would further boost the Make in India initiative for TV sets and go a long way for self-reliance.

Samsung might shift smartphone production in India

Samsung may shift a major part of its smartphone production to India from Vietnam and other countries with the South Korean electronics major finalising plans to produce devices worth over forty billion dollars in the country.

"Samsung is likely to diversify its production lines for making smartphones to India under the PLI (Production Linked Incentive) scheme, and this will have an impact on its existing capabilities across various countries like Vietnam," a person familiar with the matter informed *The Economic Times*. Vietnam is the world's second-largest exporter of smartphones after China.

Indian startup ION Energy signs big deal with esVolta

esVolta has selected ION Energy to improve the operational efficiency of its utility-scale battery energy storage projects, in one of the largest such deals in the world. Under the partnership, ION Energy's battery analytics platform, Edison Analytics, will be deployed across esVolta's entire portfolio of battery energy storage projects in North America, totalling to 581MWh of energy storage.

Unlike generic platforms, Edison, as per the company, is designed to improve the operational efficiency of battery energy storage systems (BESS) by reducing battery degradation and maximising energy trading revenues. esVolta has decided to deploy Edison Analytics across its entire portfolio of energy storage systems across ten locations in North America.

BEL equips government schools in Yadgir district with smart class facilities

Navratna Defence PSU Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL) has, as part of its CSR initiatives, empowered around 13,000 children studying in 122 government high schools of Yadgir district, Karnataka, by equipping these schools with solar-powered smart class facilities. The total cost of the project is 38.4 million rupees.

The solar-powered smart class facility offers visually attractive content that helps students to assimilate information more effectively. It facilitates teachers to explain difficult concepts easily, improves teaching effectiveness, and enhances the academic performance of students.

The smart class facilities provided by BEL to the government schools include a 127cm (50-inch) LED TV, CPU with accessories, green board, and LED lights, all of which are powered by a standalone solar PV power system with battery.

A cabinet has also been provided to store all the equipment. The digital educational content covers subjects such as English, Mathematics, Science, and Social Science for students of 8th, 9th and 10th classes.

Apart from the smart class facility, BEL is also installing handwash facility in hundred government primary schools in Yadgir.